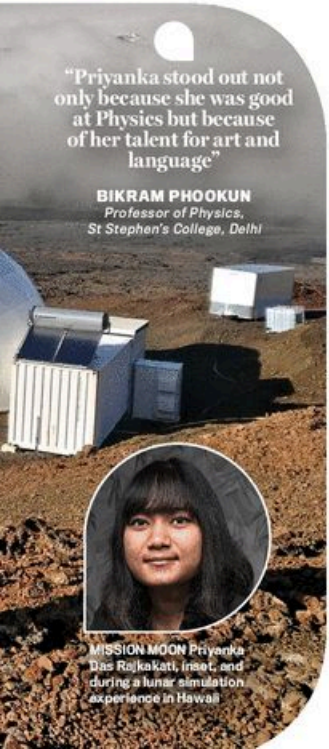
foundation. This fellowship brings together 15 individuals below 45 with outstanding accomplishments in space. Priyanka plans to run outreach campaigns in her home state Assam to create awareness about how space technologies can be used to better everyday life. She also seeks to explore and showcase the harmonious existence of arts and science in every sphere of human life—from a remote village in Assam to the most high-tech first-world cities. ■

–Kaushik Deka



MISSION MOON Priyanka Das Rajkakati, inset, and during a lunar simulation experience in Hawaii

EARTHLY STRUGGLE She had to relearn to walk after meeting with a serious accident at the age of 25



RAVI PRAKASH, 31

Dairy technology researcher **Bengaluru**

White Revolutionary

A steel milk pail with a power charger that can chill milk in 30 minutes has the potential to revolutionise India's dairy industry. The nano fluid-based technology pail can store seven litres of milk and chill it from 37°C to 7°C in 30 minutes. The innovator, dairy technologist Ravi Prakash, who is pursuing a doctorate at the, Indian Council of Agricultural Research-National Dairy Research Institute (NDRI), Bengaluru, expects to make the pail, costing about Rs 9,000 in the early prototype iterations, affordable. With financial grants from NDRI, he invested over Rs 10 lakh to design a system that cools raw milk from ambient temperature to below the critical limit. "After milking, time is of the essence in preserving quality as the farmer ferries it to the collection centre on its way to the chilling centre, twice a day," says Prakash. His experience as the son of a farmer from Harsari in the West Champaran district of Bihar, and his education (a BTech degree from NDRI, Karnal), prompted him to prepare the prototype of the pail. The device fetched him the BRICS Young Innovator Prize in 2019 that included a cash award of $25,000. He expects his invention to be available to farmers at less than Rs 5,000 by mid-2023. ■

"Frugal yet high-tech innovations can change farmers' lives, especially in India's unorganised dairy farming sector"

–Amarnath K. Menon

MULTI-BILLION OPPORTUNITY The government's National Action Plan for Dairy Development projects needs 880,000 rapid milk chillers worth over Rs 2,100 crore by 2022